Unit 7 — Mediation: A Workplace Text

Track G+M · Klasse 10 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can mediate a German workplace policy text into 6–8 English sentences for a colleague.*
- *I can preserve modal nuance (*sollten → *should*; *müssen* → *must*) and adjust register.
- *I can use 7 reporting verbs.*

Lead-in I

Sam's mother forwarded a German policy update from her company. Sam's English-speaking cousin in Toronto, who is starting a similar job, asked for a quick gist. Sam rewrote it in seven sentences. He kept the modals. He dropped the company-letterhead language.

Vocabulary I

- to announce
- to require
- to permit
- to expect
- to warn
- to advise
- to clarify
- to confirm
- to stipulate
- to reserve the right to

Reading I

Source — *German workplace policy (excerpt)*
Sehr geehrte Mitarbeiterinnen und Mitarbeiter, ab dem 1. Juli gilt eine neue Regelung zum mobilen Arbeiten. Mitarbeitende dürfen bis zu drei Tage pro Woche im Homeoffice arbeiten, sofern dies vorher mit der Führungskraft abgestimmt wurde. Die Anwesenheit an einem festen Bürotag pro Woche wird vorausgesetzt. Bei Verstößen behält sich die Geschäftsleitung Maßnahmen vor.

Mediation — modal mapping
German *dürfen* → English *may / are allowed to / can*. German *müssen* → English *must / have to*. German *sollen / sollten* → English *should*. Keep the modal nuance — *should* and *must* are not interchangeable in English.

Reading II

Reporting verbs (workplace register)
to announce, to require, to permit, to expect, to warn, to advise, to clarify, to confirm, to stipulate, to reserve the right to.

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Match German modal → English: dürfen → ?, müssen → ?, sollten → ?
2. Choose: *announce / warn / clarify / require* — Management _____ a new rule. The company _____ that breaches will be addressed.

Niveau M

3. Build a 6-sentence English mediation of the source above.

Your turn I

Mediation, 7 sentences. Read the German source above. Write 7 English sentences for a colleague abroad. Keep modal nuance + use 4 reporting verbs.

Sample

Hi Jordan, here's the gist of the new policy. The company has announced a new home-office rule starting 1 July. Employees may work from home up to three days a week, provided that this is agreed in advance with their line manager. Attendance at one fixed office day per week is required. Management warns that breaches may result in measures, though the policy doesn't say what those are. The tone is cautious — they confirm that the rule is conditional on prior approval. In short: hybrid is allowed, but not automatic.

Reflect I

- I can mediate a German policy into 7 English sentences.
- I can preserve modal nuance.
- I can use 4 reporting verbs.

Further reading / listening I

- Goethe-Institut — Sprachmittlungs-Beispielaufgaben.
- Cambridge Business English — accessible policy-text samples.